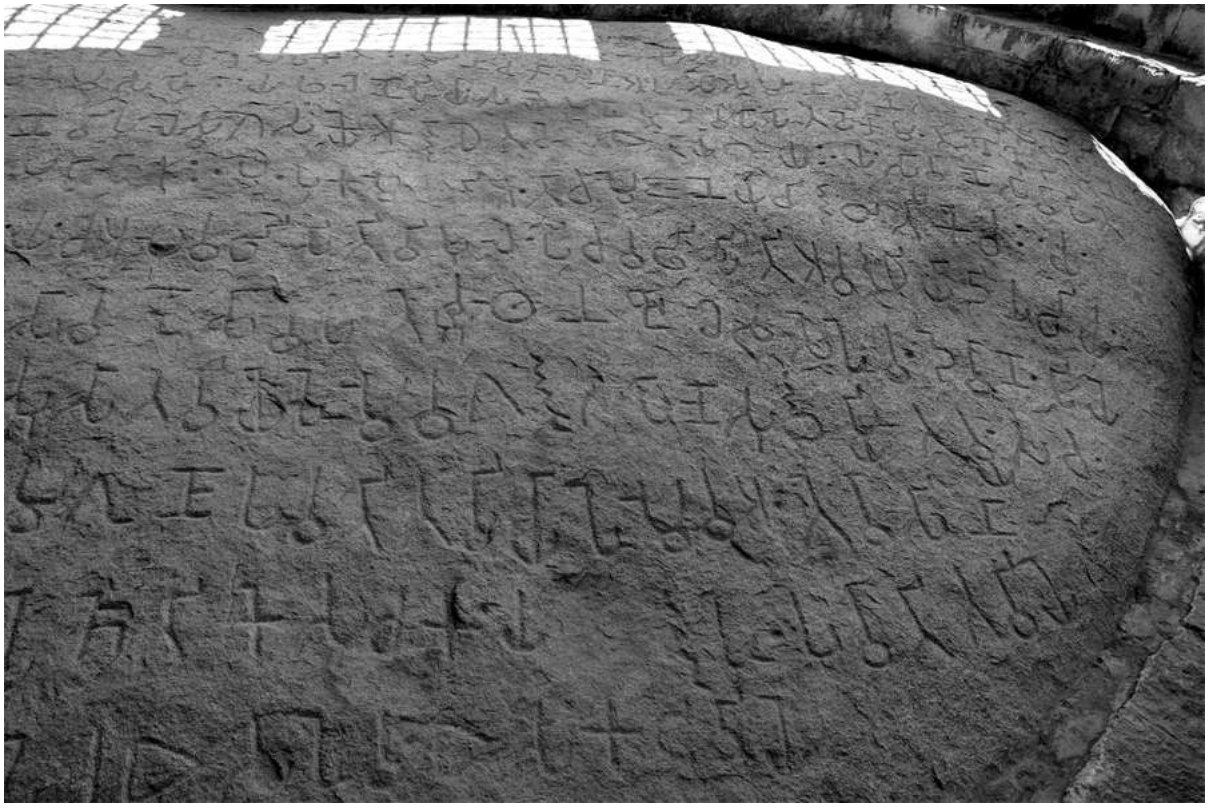


Fig. 6.8: Brahmagiri edict

Has Isila been identified on the ground? In 1940 the archaeologist M.H. Krishna believed he had searched out ancient Isila a little ahead of the edict-bearing rock, and the place was so described by a later excavator of Brahmagiri:

> The northern slopes of Brahmagiri, largely covered by a tumbled mass of granite boulders, bear extensive signs of ancient occupation in the form of pot-sherds, fragmentary walls and remains of small terraced platforms roughly revetted with dry-stone walling. It is to be presumed that two thousand years ago more earth remained amongst the boulders than at the present day, and that much evidence of this part of Isila has been washed away. But at all times the main area of occupation must have lain, as surface-remains and excavation combine to indicate, along the gentle slope which forms the transition from the hill to the plain. Here a long strip some 200 yards in width is a mass of occupation-earth and sherds. Beyond it, the fringe of the plain itself, to a depth of 500 yards or more and a length of about a mile, forms what must have been an almost